

课程大纲

COURSE SYLLABUS

1.	课程代码/名称 Course Code/Title	Writing for Publication
2.	课程性质 Compulsory/Elective	Compulsory
3.	开课单位 Offering Dept.	Center for Language Education
4.	课程学分/学时 Course Credit/Hours	2 credits/32 hour
5.	授课语言 Teaching Language	English
6.	授课教师 Instructor(s)	Adrian Rowland
7.	开课学期 Semester	Spring
8.	是否面向本科生开放 Open to undergraduates or not	No
9.	先修要求 Pre-requisites	（如面向本科生开放，请注明区分内容。 If the course is open to undergraduates, please indicate the difference.） No
10.	教学目标 Course Objectives	
	（如面向本科生开放，请注明区分内容。 If the course is open to undergraduates, please indicate the difference.） This is a writing course. It aims to help students write better scientific papers. It covers three main areas: - ideas about the purpose and typical contents of each section of a scientific paper; - points of grammar and style for scientific writing. It will examine the tense conventions for each section of a scientific paper, the use of active and passive voice to lend appropriate emphasis, and aspects of sentence structure, paragraph structure, and word choice to promote the clear flow of ideas; - techniques for effectively structuring and telling stories, promoting a broader view of a scientific paper as a story-telling medium. Though this course focuses on writing papers, the skills developed will also aid other forms of scientific communication, such as writing theses, proposals, and emails.	
11.	教学方法 Teaching Methods	
	（如面向本科生开放，请注明区分内容。 If the course is open to undergraduates, please indicate the difference.） Most weeks, the lesson will be split into two parts. In the first part, new ideas about scientific writing will be examined. This part of the lesson will be somewhere between a lecture and a seminar, with discussion highly encouraged. In the second half, students will apply these ideas by working on either on their mini-paper (a piece of writing in the style of the introduction to a scientific paper) or on other exercises while the instructor circulates, reading students' work and offering informal feedback.	
12.	教学内容	

Course Contents

(如面向本科生开放, 请注明区分内容。 If the course is open to undergraduates, please indicate the difference.)

Sections 1-2	The basics: - Course overview and introduction to the mini-paper; - Basic philosophy of scientific writing and the aims of a scientific paper, including the idea of a scientific paper as a story; - Familiarisation with a paper chosen as exemplar material for the course. Overall view of a scientific paper: - generic IMRAD structure of an experimental paper and brief survey of the function of each section; - Some ideas about story structure, including the acronym OCAR; - The “hourglass” shape of a scientific paper. Writing introductions: - generic IMRAD structure of an experimental paper and brief survey of the function of each section; - A detailed look at the purpose of an introduction in terms of the OCAR model, with an especial focus on the idea of the <i>challenge</i>; - The topic width of the introduction; - The importance of concrete context; - The function of the introduction as a preview; - Errors to avoid when writing introductions.
Section 3	Use of tense when writing an introduction: - The typical uses of the simple present, present perfect, and simple past tenses within an introduction; - Time to work on mini-paper.
Section 4	AI writing aids: - Examination of case studies of the performance of LLMs and Grammarly at editing real academic writing; - Summary of strengths and weaknesses of AI writing aids and discussion of implications for the writing process.
Section 5	Independent resources for supporting writing: - The Academic Phrase Bank; - Using corpora to view vocabulary in context; - English-corpora.org, if available; - The CLE Corpus; - Potential ways students can use corpora to improve their writing by examining differences between their own writing and the writing of experts in their field; - Peer review of mini-paper.
Section 6	Tense and voice in scientific writing: - Use of tense in the method section and the results and discussion section; - Use of voice in the method section as a tool to emphasise or de-emphasise author involvement; - Reasons to emphasise or de-emphasise author involvement; - Style in the construction of the passive voice; avoiding excessively remote verbs; - Analysis of use of passive and active voices in examples from the literature.
Section 7	Writing an abstract: - Aims and typical structure and contents of an abstract; - The importance of the abstract standing alone; - Accessibility to non-specialist readers; - Conventions regarding abbreviations and citations; - Concise and direct writing in abstracts; - Analysis of several abstracts from the literature.
Section 8	Common problems in student writing: - Comma splices; - Fragments; - Poor style with conjunctions; - Wrong choice of conditional structure; - Confusion between <i>can</i> and <i>could</i>; - Commonly misused words (e.g. <i>besides</i> and <i>moreover</i>); - Overuse of “how to”, “has always been”, “as a...”, “with the development of”; - Review of students' own writing.

Section 9	Concision and formality: - Fuzzy verbs; - Redundant words and obvious information; - Adjectives and adverbs; - Metadiscourse; - Unnecessary abstract → concrete structure; - Imperative mood; - Punctuation; - Rhetorical questions; - Contractions; - Vagueness and run-on expressions; - Addressing the reader; - Negatives; - Review of students' own writing.
Section 10	Order of information within sentences I: - The given → new principle, referred to simplistically as <i>cohesion</i> in this course; - Using cohesion to find logical gaps; - Improving cohesion; - Limits of cohesion; - Cohesion and AI; - Review of students' own writing.
Section 11	Order of information within sentences II: - Sentence stress; - The idea of the stress position in simple sentences; - 2-3-1 sentence stress in simple sentences; - Sentences that are too short and sentences that are too long; - Coherence of sentence topics; - Review of students' own writing.
Section 12	Order of information within sentences III: - Topic stringing and topic changing; - Interplay between stress and coherence; - Interplay between cohesion and coherence; - Review of students' own writing. Advanced punctuation: - Basic function of colons; - Use of colons to create stress positions; - Colon grammar; - Use of the semicolon as a super-comma; - Review of students' own writing.
Section 13	Paragraph structure I: - Two types of common paragraph structure in scientific writing, <i>LD</i> and <i>LDR</i>; - Positioning of key information within paragraphs; - Common mistakes with paragraph construction; - Analysis of examples from the literature; - Review of students' own writing.
Section 14	Paragraph structure II: - Two more common paragraph types in scientific writing, <i>L</i> and <i>narrative</i>; - Paragraph length; - Things to consider when dividing your writing into paragraphs; - AI and paragraphing; - Review of students' own writing.
Section 15	Course review: - Review of course content.
Section 16	Preparation and practice for final exam
13. 课程考核 Course Assessment	
(① 考核形式 Form of examination; ②. 分数构成 grading policy; ③ 如面向本科生开放, 请注明区分内容。 If the course is open to undergraduates, please indicate the difference.) Participation 10% Students are expected to arrive on time and engage in class activities, especially peer review of writing.	

	Engagement and performance 20% Verbal discussion of new ideas and their exemplification by the scientific literature is a central part of this course. Mini-paper 20% The mini-paper is written predominantly in weeks 2-5 and submitted in week 6. Final exam 50% This takes place at the end of the semester. It assesses students' ability to recall and apply the writing ideas discussed during the course.
14.	教材及其它参考资料 Textbook and Supplementary Readings
	David Lindsay, <i>Scientific Writing = Thinking in Words</i>, CSIRO Publishing, Melbourne, 2020 Michael Alley, <i>The Craft of Scientific Writing</i>, Springer, New York, 2018 Both books are available in electronic format via the university library, so students will not need to purchase them.

以上课程信息可能根据实际授课需要或在课程优化之后产生变动。如对课程有任何疑问，请联系授课教师。

The course information as follows may be subject to change, either during the session because of unforeseen circumstances, or following review of the course at the end of the session. Queries about the course should be directed to the course instructor.